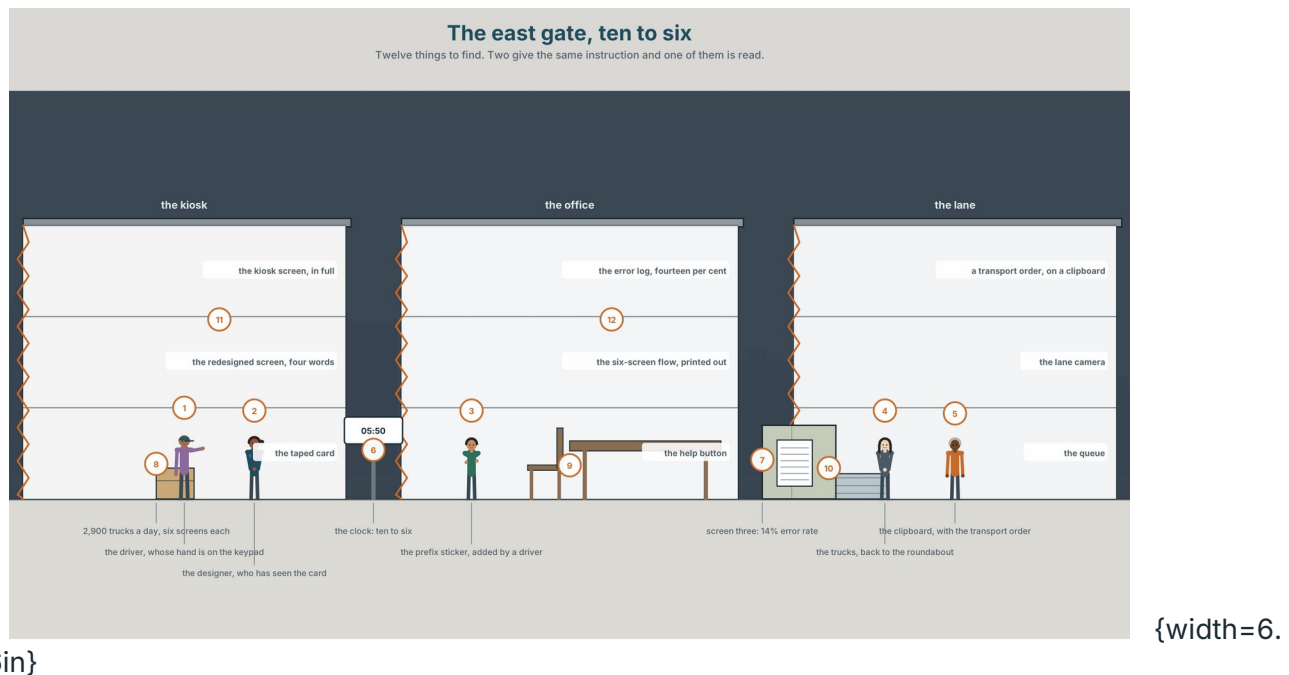


Table of Contents

B2.2 • Unit 7 • Twenty-Four Words at a Gate

English Animated • *Holding the Floor* • a port and its logistics chain, Rotterdam Student's
Book pages 138–159 • 22 pp • ~11 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

The east gate, ten to six — Twelve things to find. Two give the same instruction and one of them is read.

What goes first and what goes last?

By the end of this unit you can put the right thing at each end of a sentence, and say what each position costs. Two hundred words.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

A gate kiosk, two thousand nine hundred trucks a day, and one instruction with a fourteen per cent error rate

fronting and end-weight • 28 words for interfaces and instructions • 22 thematic words and frames • end-focus

Two hundred words in which every

◆ A • THE WORLD

A gate kiosk, two thousand nine hundred trucks a day, and one instruction with a fourteen per cent error rate
sentence ends where you meant it to

0A • Find it

Find twelve things in this picture. Two of them give the same instruction and one of them is read.

the kiosk screen, instruction in full · the redesigned screen, four words · the error log, fourteen per cent · the queue of trucks, back to the roundabout · a transport order on a clipboard · a driver's hand on the keypad · the help button nobody presses · the prefix sticker added by a driver · the lane camera · a clock at 05.50 · a laminated card taped to the kiosk · the six-screen flow printed out

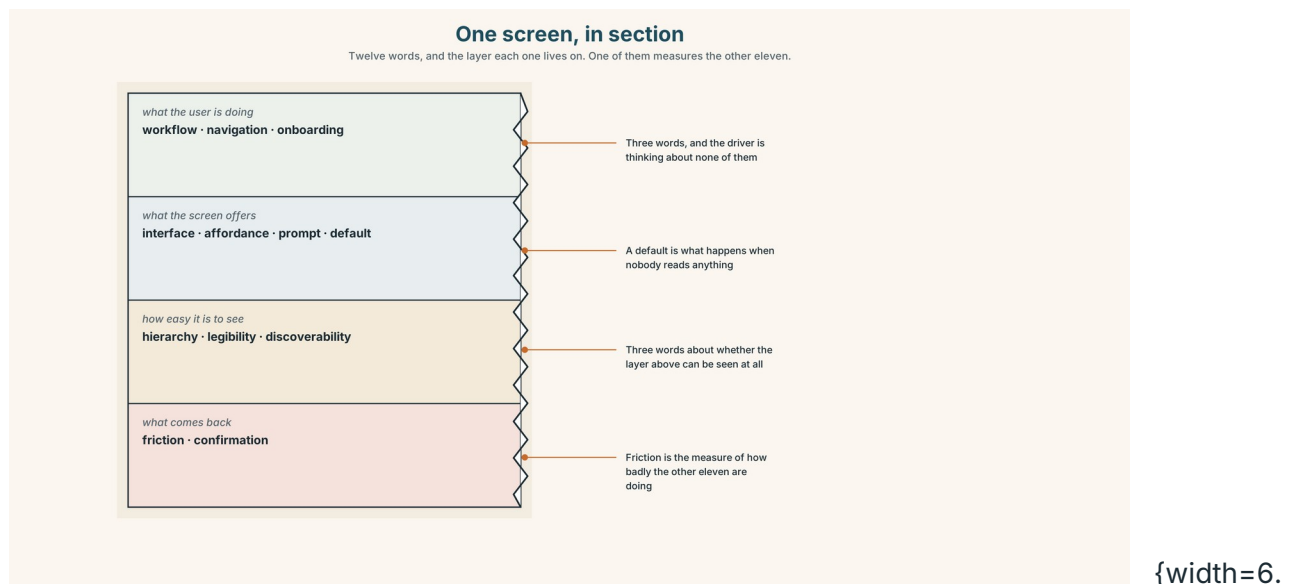
0B • Guess it

One thing in this picture was added by the people the kiosk is for, and it fixes the instruction better than the instruction does. Which, and what does that tell the designer?

0C • Say it

Record sixty seconds. Give instructions for something you do every day, to somebody who has never done it. You will record it again at the end of this unit.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM



6in}

One screen, in section — Twelve words, and the layer each one lives on. One of them measures the other eleven.

1A • Meet — the words of an interface

Match each word to one layer of the cutaway.

interface · affordance · workflow · prompt · onboarding · friction · navigation · hierarchy · legibility · discoverability · default · confirmation

1B • Sort — what the user is doing, what the screen offers, or how easy it is to use?

Three columns. **One of the twelve is a measure of how badly the other eleven are doing.**

workflow · interface · hierarchy · navigation · affordance · legibility · onboarding · prompt · discoverability · default · friction · confirmation

1C • Meet — the five things on every screen

a default setting	What happens if the user does nothing, which is what most of them do.
the critical action	The one thing this screen exists for. Usually not the biggest element.
an error state	The screen a user sees most often and the one designed last.
a dead end	A screen with no way forward that does not say so.
the happy path	The route taken by a user who makes no mistakes, and by almost nobody.

1D • Collocation Lab

Complete each one, and say which of the five is the only one a driver ever reads twice.

step one of four · a confirmation screen · the primary button · a help string · the first run

1. _____ tells the user how long this is going to take.
2. _____ is grey on grey and sits below the fold.
3. _____ repeats the booking reference so that it can be checked.
4. _____ runs to twenty-four words and is read by nobody.
5. _____ is the only time a driver is paying attention, and it happens once.

1E • The phrasal verbs, and the three fixed expressions

walk through · click through · opt out

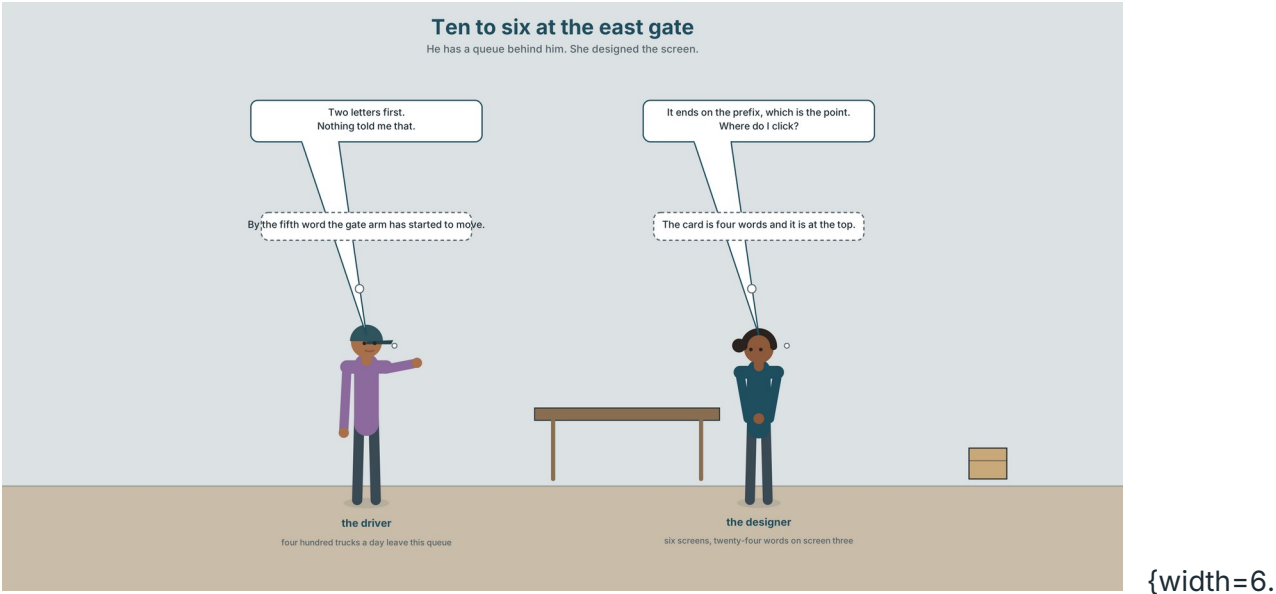
ƒ where do I click · ƒ what happens if I · ƒ nothing told me that

One of these fixed expressions is the only honest measure of an interface. Which, and why can it only be heard and never designed for?

1F • Own it

Write one instruction you give people often, twice: once with the action first and once with the condition first.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

Ten to six at the east gate — He has a queue behind him. She designed the screen.

2A • Ten to six 🎧 Track 7.1

Before you listen. Two thousand nine hundred trucks arrive a day. The booking-reference screen has a fourteen per cent error rate. A driver has taped a card to the kiosk.

Listen once. What does the instruction say, and what do drivers actually do?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	What the screen says	What the driver does	Where it goes wrong
screen 3			
the error state			
the taped card			

Listen again. True or false?

- 1. Two thousand nine hundred trucks arrive a day. ☐ T ☐ F
- 2. The instruction is twenty-four words. ☐ T ☐ F
- 3. The error rate is four per cent. ☐ T ☐ F
- 4. A driver added the prefix sticker. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Six versions of the same instruction.

- 1. Please ensure that the booking reference, which can be found on your transport order, is entered in full including the prefix.
- 2. Enter the booking reference in full, including the prefix.
- 3. Including the prefix, enter the booking reference in full.
- 4. The booking reference is what you enter here — in full, including the prefix.
- 5. Enter your booking reference. It begins with two letters.

6. What you must include is the two-letter prefix.

Six versions, one instruction. Say which word each version ends on, and which of the six a driver in a queue would get right.

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 7.2

Thirty seconds at speed. Three jobs.

1. One speaker reads version 1 aloud. Mark where the voice falls, and count how many falls there are.
2. Which word carries the last stress in version 5, and why does that matter?
3. Somebody says *nothing told me that*. What had they just done?

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

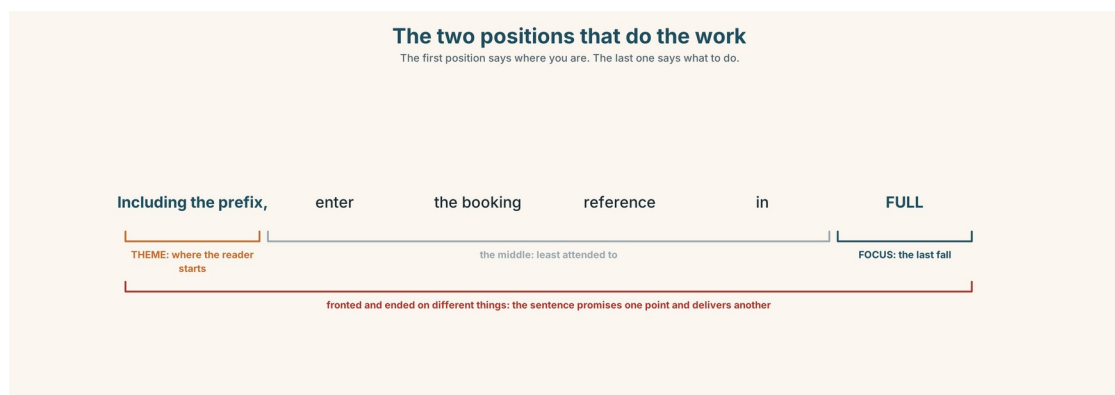
The first position and the last position do different jobs

3A • Notice

Look at the six versions in Part 2 again.

1. Version 1 ends on *prefix*. **Why is that the wrong word to end on, if the prefix is the problem?**
2. Version 3 fronts a phrase. **What does fronting it promise, and does the sentence keep the promise?**
3. Version 5 is two sentences. **What has the split bought?**
4. Version 6 is a pseudo-cleft. **Where does it put the prefix, and what does that cost?**

3B • See



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6in}

The two positions that do the work — The first position says where you are. The last one says what to do.

3C • Know

the first position
(theme)

what the sentence is
about; the reader's
starting point

Including the prefix, ...

the last position (focus)	the new information; where the voice falls	<i>...including the prefix.</i>
fronting	moving something to the front for contrast or linkage	<i>The prefix you must include.</i>
end-weight	long and heavy elements go last, short ones first	<i>Enter, in full, the reference printed on your order.</i>
extraposition	a heavy subject is moved to the end and it holds its place	<i>It is essential to include the prefix.</i>
the conflict	you cannot front a thing and also end on it	and most bad instructions try

English puts old information first and new information last. The first position tells the reader where they are; the last position tells them what to do with it. A sentence that puts the new fact first and a familiar one last has been read backwards, and the reader will have to do it twice.

End-weight is not a style rule. *Enter the reference printed on your transport order in full* is hard because a long noun phrase has been pushed into the middle. Move it to the end and the sentence works: *Enter in full the reference printed on your transport order.*

fronting for emphasis	<i>more important is · what matters most is · central to this is</i>
marking position in a list	<i>first · foremost · last of all · chief among them · last but not least</i>
adding weight at the end	<i>worse still · no less important · and finally</i>
what writers do with order	<i>lead with · end on · put off</i>

Why it matters. An instruction is read once, at speed, by somebody who is already doing something else. The last word of each sentence is the one that survives, which means the order of the words is the design.

3D • Use — controlled

Rewrite each one so that it ends on the word in brackets.

Enter the booking reference in full, including the prefix. (1) (*prefix*) You must include the two-letter prefix. (2) (*prefix*) The reference printed on your transport order must be entered in full. (3) (*full*) It is essential to include the prefix. (4) (*prefix*) Check the reference before you press confirm. (5) (*confirm*)

3E • Use — guided

Rewrite each one using end-weight, moving the heavy element to the end.

1. The reference printed on your transport order must be entered in full.
2. That the prefix is two letters is not obvious.
3. Whether the driver has the order in the cab is the real question.

4. A screen that nobody reads twice was designed last.
5. To enter the reference without the prefix is the commonest error.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. One of you gives an instruction. The other says the last word back. **If it is not the word that matters, the first speaker rewrites it.** Six rounds each.

3G • Error autopsy

× Including the prefix, the reference must be entered in full including the prefix. × That the prefix is two letters is not obvious to most drivers who are in a queue. × Enter the reference printed on your transport order which begins with two letters in full.

For each, name the rule and say what the writer was reaching for.

3H • Check — eight items

1. Rewrite *Enter the reference in full, including the prefix* so that it ends on *prefix*.
 2. Rewrite *The reference printed on your order must be entered in full* with end-weight.
 3. Rewrite *That the prefix is two letters is not obvious* with extraposition.
 4. _____ is the two-letter prefix. (*three words — a fronted focus frame*)
 5. _____, check the order in your cab. (*two words — first in a list*)
 6. × *Enter the reference printed on your transport order which begins with two letters in full.*
→ correct it.
 7. Write one instruction of eight words or fewer that ends on its critical element.
 8. Write the same instruction fronted, and say what you lost.
-

Part 4 • Speaking ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — end on it

One person names a word. The next makes a sentence ending on that word. **The third says whether the sentence sounds natural or forced** — and if forced, says which position the word wanted.

4B • The functional core — ordering a sentence

Screen three, two versions
One of them has a fourteen per cent error rate. One of them is a card taped to the kiosk.

as installed

24 words · 1 sentence · 3 falls · 14% errors

Find the six. One version ends its first sentence on the thing the driver gets wrong. Which, and in how many words?

6 differences — find them all

as rewritten

9 words · 2 sentences · 2 falls · 3% errors

{width=6.

6in}

Screen three, two versions — One of them has a fourteen per cent error rate. One of them is a card taped to the kiosk.

Language Bank

fronting

more important is · what matters
most is · central to this is · at the
heart of it

ordering

first · foremost · last of all · chief
among them

weighting the end

worse still · no less important · and
finally

talking about order

lead with · end on · put off

Information gap. Learner A has the six kiosk screens. Learner B has the error log. **Agree on one new instruction for screen three.** Ten minutes.

4C • The performance — three minutes

Explain a procedure in three minutes. **Every sentence must end on the word you want remembered**, and your partner writes down the last word of each and reads the list back.

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person writes the last word of every sentence and marks whether it was the point.

4E • Three criteria

- ☐ Did each sentence end where I meant it to? ☐ Did I front anything, and did the sentence keep that promise? ☐ Was the heaviest element at the end of its sentence?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**The card somebody taped to the kiosk.**" If users fix an instruction themselves, what have they told you?

5B • Read — two minutes

The card somebody taped to the kiosk

Two thousand nine hundred trucks arrive at the east gate each day. Each driver passes through six kiosk screens. Screen three asks for the booking reference.

The instruction on screen three reads: *Please ensure that the booking reference, which can be found on your transport order, is entered in full including the prefix.* Twenty-four words. The error rate on that screen is fourteen per cent, which is about four hundred trucks a day entering a queue they will have to leave.

Every error is the same error. The prefix is two letters. Drivers enter the six digits and omit them.

The sentence ends on *prefix*, which is the one piece of information that matters, and that ought to be right. It is not, because by the time a driver reaches the end of a twenty-four word sentence in a queue at ten to six in the morning, they have already started typing.

At some point in the last year somebody taped a card to the kiosk. It says, in marker pen, 2 **LETTERS FIRST**. Four words, at the top, where the hand is.

The error rate at that kiosk is three per cent. It is the only one of the twelve gates where anybody has measured it, because it is the only one where anybody noticed.

5C • Comprehension — eight questions

1. How many trucks arrive, and how many screens are there?
2. How long is the instruction, and what is the error rate?
3. How many trucks a day is that?
4. What is the error, every time?
5. What does the taped card say, and in how many words?
6. **The sentence ends on the right word and still fails. Why?**
7. **Why does the writer mention the time of day?**
8. **The last paragraph contains two facts about measurement. What is the writer saying about the other eleven gates?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Infer from the text, then check.

passes through six kiosk screens · a queue they will have to leave · ought to be right · where the hand is · the only one where anybody noticed

5E • The counter-text

Six screens, and where each one ends

The critical action on each, and the word the driver is left holding.

EAST GATE KIOSK - SIX SCREENS - 2,900 ARRIVALS A DAY

SCREEN 3: "Please ensure that the booking reference, which can be found on your transport order, is entered in full including the prefix."

THE CARD, TAPED TO THE SAME KIOSK, IN MARKER PEN: "2 LETTERS FIRST."

SCREEN	ENDS ON	ERROR RATE
1 VEHICLE PLATE	PLATE	1%
2 HAULER CODE	SYSTEM	4%
3 BOOKING REFERENCE	PREFIX	14%
4 TRAILER NUMBER	CAB	2%
5 CONFIRMATION	DISPLAYED	--
6 LANE ALLOCATION	ALLOCATED	--
THE TAPED CARD	FIRST	3%
WORDS ON SCREEN 3	24	--

WHY SCREEN 3 FAILS THOUGH IT ENDS ON THE POINT

three falls, not one

three corrections, and only one applies

the heavy clause

sits in the middle, where nobody reads

twenty-four words

the gate arm moves at about the fifth

the card: four words

at the top, where the hand already is

Screens 5 and 6 end on verbs that describe what the system does. Nobody has ever measured those two, because nothing visibly goes wrong on them.

Twenty-four words, and the first five are a politeness

Four words, in marker pen, with a three per cent error rate

One screen in six carries three quarters of the errors

Ending on the right word is not enough if you end three times

The two unmeasured screens are the two with no visible failure

{width=6.

6in}

Six screens, and where each one ends — The critical action on each, and the word the driver is left holding.

Read the six screens and answer.

1. What is the critical action on each screen, and where does it appear?

2. Find every sentence that ends on something that is not the point.

3. Screen five is a confirmation. What does it put in the last position, and should it?

4. Rewrite screens three and five so that each ends on its critical element.

5F • Two texts

The kiosk says ...is entered in full including the prefix. The card says 2 LETTERS FIRST.

Which is the instruction? Write two sentences, and use the word *friction* in one of them.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Words that claim a position

6A • Sort — first, after that, or last and worse?

Three columns.

first • thus • last • foremost • thereupon • worse • henceforth • further

6B • Chunk completion

1. _____ the order in your cab. (*three words — the fronted focus*)
2. _____ is the two-letter prefix. (*four words*)
3. _____ is the queue behind you. (*four words*)
4. _____ is the time it takes. (*four words*)
5. _____, check the trailer number. (*three words — the end of a list*)
6. _____, the error state is unreadable. (*two words — and it gets worse*)
7. _____ is the confirmation screen. (*four words — equal weight*)
8. _____ are the four hundred trucks a day. (*three words — out of a set*)

6C • Three that are not interchangeable

first · foremost · first of all

Say which one orders a list, which one ranks importance, and which one announces that a list is starting.

6D • The phrasal verbs and the fixed expressions

lead with · end on · put off

f *first things first · f last but not least · f and finally*

Two of these fixed expressions make a promise about what is coming and one makes a claim about what has just been said. Which is which?

6E • Contrast Clinic

Eight items. Reorder each sentence as the bracket asks.

1. Enter the reference in full, including the prefix. (*end on the prefix*)
 2. The reference printed on your transport order must be entered in full. (*end-weight*)
 3. That the prefix is two letters is not obvious. (*extraposition*)
 4. The prefix is the thing you must include. (*a fronted focus frame*)
 5. The queue behind you is the real cost. (*front the cost*)
 6. The confirmation screen is no less important than the entry screen. (*end on the confirmation*)
 7. Check the order in your cab before you start. (*front the check*)
 8. Four hundred trucks a day leave the queue. (*end on the number*)
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

One fall, and it names the error
The last stressed word is the mistake you are correcting.

en-ter	the	ref	in	FULL	somebody entered part of it
en-ter	the	REF	in	full	somebody entered something else
two	let-ters	FIRST			three words, one fall, hand already there
please	en-sure	that	the	REF	five words before the instruction starts

{width=6.

6in}

One fall, and it names the error — The last stressed word is the mistake you are correcting.

The last stressed word is the instruction

7A • Hear 🎧 Track 7.3

Enter the reference in full, including the PREFIX. — one fall, at the end, on the point Please ensure that the booking REFERENCE, which can be found on your transport ORDER, is entered in full including the PREFIX. — three falls, and the first two are not instructions Two letters FIRST. — one fall, three words, and the hand is already there

7B • Say

Say all three. Then say this, with exactly one fall:

Enter your reference in full, with the two-letter prefix.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

Enter the reference in FULL. — and somebody has been entering part of it Enter the REFERENCE in full. — and somebody has been entering something else

The last stressed word names the error you are correcting, which is why an instruction with three falls in it is three different corrections and a driver has to guess which one applies.

7D • Fluency 30 🟡

Thirty seconds: **four instructions, each with exactly one fall, each on a different word.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

An instruction set that ends in the right places • 200 words

8A • Read the model

Enter your booking reference. [four words, one fall, and the fall is on the thing being entered]

It begins with two letters. [extraposed and short: the new fact is alone at the end of a five-word sentence, where it cannot be missed]

More important than the digits is the prefix, which is the only part most drivers omit. [fronted comparison, and the heavy relative clause has been pushed to the end where it belongs]

Last of all, check the trailer number against the order in your cab; without it, the gate will not open. [a list marker at the front, the heaviest element last, and the consequence in the final position because that is the one drivers repeat to each other]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The second sentence is five words long. **What would putting it inside the first have cost?**
2. The third sentence fronts a comparison. **What does the front position promise here?**
3. The last sentence ends on a consequence rather than an action. **Why, in an instruction?**

8B • The anti-model

Please ensure that all required fields, including the booking reference, which can be found on your transport order, and the trailer number, are completed in full before proceeding to the confirmation screen, which will then be displayed.

One sentence, thirty-six words, four heavy elements in the middle, and it ends on something that happens by itself. **Rewrite it as four sentences, each ending on something the driver does.**

8C • Plan

the action, four words → the new fact, alone at the end → the fronted comparison with its heavy clause last → the list marker, the heavy element, and the consequence

8D • Write — 200 words

8E • Peer review — three criteria

☐ Does each sentence end on the thing you want remembered? ☐ Is the heaviest element in each sentence at its end? ☐ Did anything get fronted that the sentence then failed to deliver?

8F • Write it again • 8G • Publish

Rewrite after review. **Publish both, and list the last word of every sentence in each.**

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Five sentences that end on nothing — A filler at the end occupies the one position a listener is attending to.

9A • ...and so on, and things like that Track 9.4

what you say	<i>I work on reports, planning, meetings and so on</i>
what the listener hears	a list that ends on nothing
what it costs	the one position a listener remembers
the fix	end on the last real item, and stop

Take three sentences you have said this week that ended on a filler. **Remove the filler and say them again.** Nothing is lost; something arrives.

In pairs. One of you speaks for thirty seconds. The other writes down the last word of every sentence and reads the list back. **Swap.** The list should read like a summary.

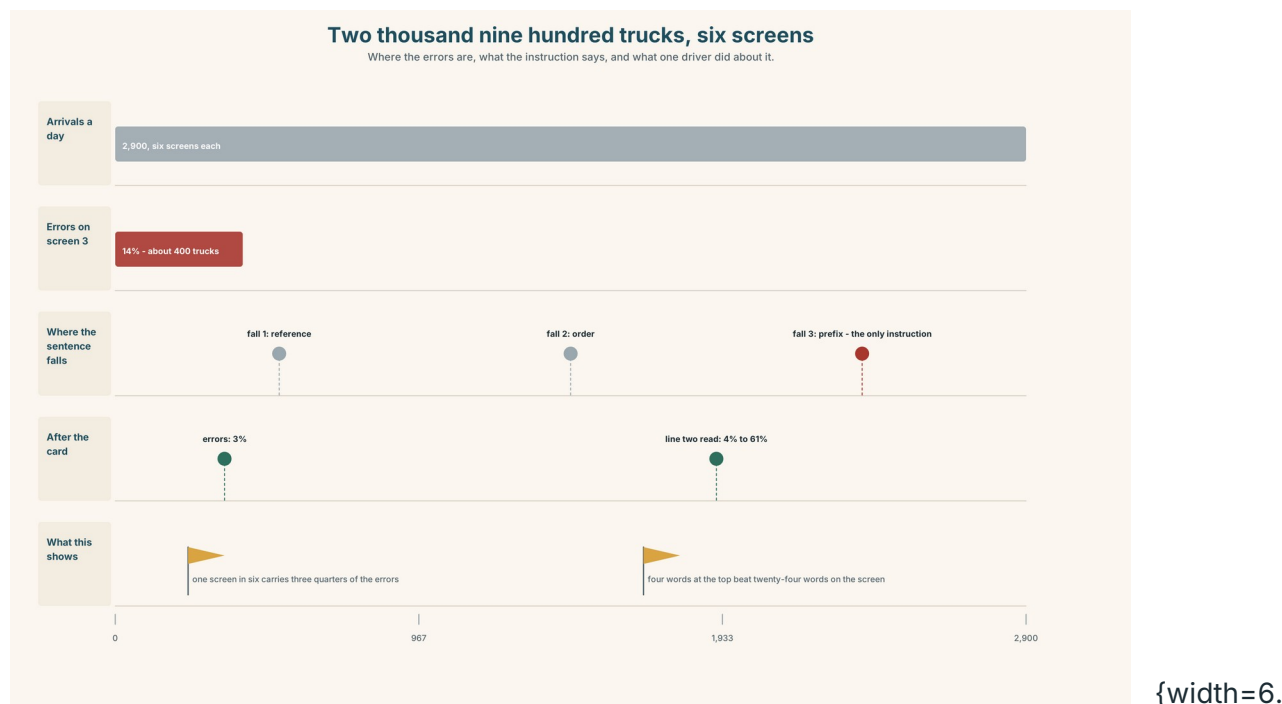
9D • The filler you own

Everybody has one. Record two minutes and count. **If more than one sentence in four ends on it, that is this week's work.**

9E • Transfer — before next week

Write six sentences about your work, and underline the last word of each. Bring them, and ask somebody to guess the topic from the six underlined words alone.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



6in}

Two thousand nine hundred trucks, six screens — Where the errors are, what the instruction says, and what one driver did about it.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the six screens. Half has the error log and the taped card. **Produce one instruction for screen three, by speaking only.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one reader

A driver writes: *Why does it reject my number?* **Reply in four sentences**, each ending on something the driver does.

10C • Online

Write **one message** to the designer about the taped card. **Three sentences.** Describe what the card does, not what the screen fails to do.

10D • Your language

Does your language put new information last, as English does? **Translate all six versions from Part 2.** Which ones end on a different word once translated?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

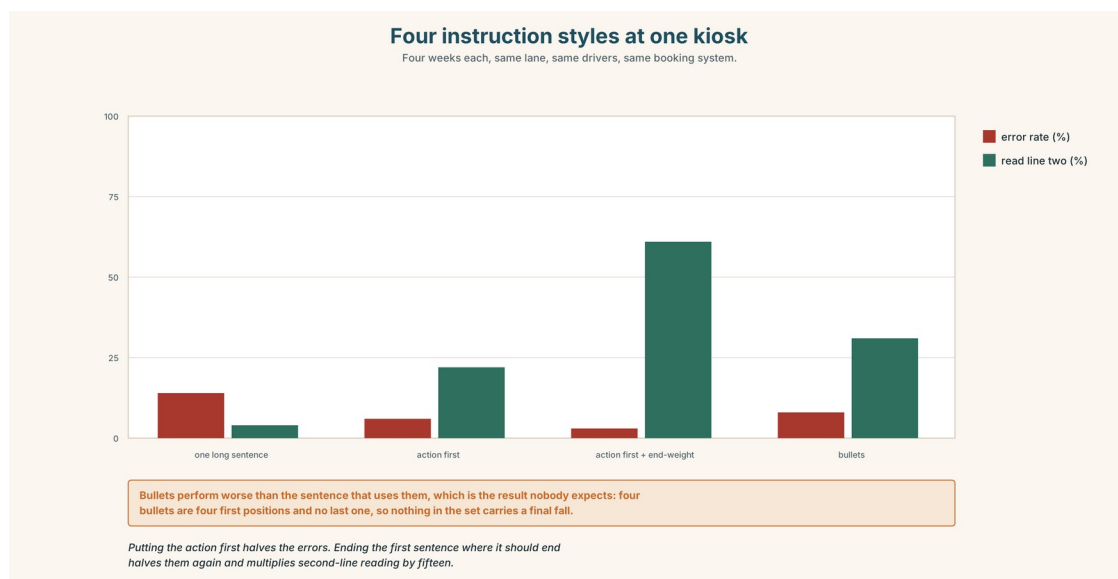
How the kiosk gives an instruction

Option one: keep the full sentence. It is complete, it is legally precise, and every field it mentions is a field the system requires.

Option two: one imperative per screen, the action first, everything else deleted.

Option three: the action first, the qualification at the end, and the single thing that varies — the prefix — in the final position of its own short sentence.

11A • The evidence



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6in}

Four instruction styles at one kiosk — Four weeks each, same lane, same drivers, same booking system.

Track 7.6. The driver who taped the card, 30 seconds: "I did not design anything. I wrote down the thing I kept getting wrong, and I put it where my hand already was. Four words, because by the fifth word the gate arm has started to move and I have stopped reading. If somebody wants to pay me for that, they can send it to the yard and I will be asleep."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame, and end every turn on the word that matters.

I would lead with _____, and end on _____, because the reader is _____.

11C • Decide

Write **three sentences**: the decision, the evidence, and the new text of screen three.

11D • Model decision

Option three. Deleting everything is the right instinct and goes one step too far: the transport-order reference is genuinely needed and a driver who has not brought it needs to know that before they start typing. The split is what does the work — one short sentence whose last word is *letters* — and the full qualification can stay, provided it is in a second sentence where it cannot push the point out of the final position.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The gate adopted the split instruction. The error rate on screen three fell from fourteen per cent to three — the same rate as the kiosk with the taped card.

Then something nobody predicted: drivers began reading the second line. Observed reading of line two rose from four per cent to sixty-one. Nothing on line two had changed. What had changed was that line one now ended, and a sentence that ends gives a reader somewhere to stop and therefore somewhere to start again.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

The second line was always there. Why did ending the first one make it readable?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — fifteen items

1. Rewrite *Enter the reference in full, including the prefix* so that it ends on *prefix*.
2. _____ is the two-letter prefix. *(four words)*
3. _____ is the queue behind you. *(four words)*
4. _____ is the time it takes. *(four words)*
5. _____, check the trailer number. *(three words)*
6. _____, the error state is unreadable. *(two words)*
7. _____ is the confirmation screen. *(four words)*
8. _____ are the four hundred trucks. *(three words)*
9. _____, check the order in your cab. *(one word)*
10. _____, the prefix. *(one word — the thing that matters most)*
11. _____ . *(three words — before anything else)*
12. _____ . *(four words — the end of a list, with a compliment)*
13. Somebody has to _____ the critical action. *(two words)*
14. Never _____ a filler. *(two words)*
15. Do not _____ the hardest screen until last. *(two words)*

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write 150 words of instructions, with one fronted element, one extraposed subject and one sentence using end-weight. Mark the last word of every sentence.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can front an element and deliver on it. **Evidence:** 3H, 8D ☐ I can use end-weight and extraposition. **Evidence:** 6E, 8D ☐ I can write an instruction that ends on its critical element. **Evidence:** 10B, 5E ☐ I can place the final fall on the word I mean. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Compare.** What did your sentences end on the first time?

12E • Glossary — fifty items, as a map

WHAT THE USER IS DOING · workflow · navigation · onboarding **WHAT THE SCREEN OFFERS** · interface · affordance · prompt · default · confirmation **HOW EASY IT IS** · hierarchy · legibility · discoverability · friction **ON EVERY SCREEN** · a default setting · the critical action · an error state · a dead end · the happy path **THE PARTS OF IT** · step one of four · a confirmation screen · the primary button · a help string · the first run **WHAT USERS DO** · walk through · click through · opt out · lead with · end on · put off **IN THE QUEUE** · where do I click · what happens if I · nothing told me that **THE POSITION WORDS** · thus · henceforth · thereupon · first · foremost · last · worse · further **THE FRAMES** · more important is · what matters most is · at the heart of it · central to this is · last of all · worse still · no less important · chief among them **OPENING AND CLOSING** · first things first · last but not least · and finally

12F • Next

Unit 8 • Whose words are those?